

HOUSE No. 743

The Commonwealth of Massachusetts

PRESENTED BY:

Marcus S. Vaughn

To the Honorable Senate and House of Representatives of the Commonwealth of Massachusetts in General Court assembled:

The undersigned legislators and/or citizens respectfully petition for the adoption of the accompanying bill:

An Act establishing a grant program to increase the presence of mental health counselors in schools.

PETITION OF:

NAME:

Marcus S. Vaughn

DISTRICT/ADDRESS:

9th Norfolk

DATE ADDED:

1/3/2025

HOUSE No. 743

By Representative Vaughn of Wrentham, a petition (accompanied by bill, House, No. 743) of Marcus S. Vaughn relative to establishing a grant program to increase the presence of mental health counselors in schools. Education.

[SIMILAR MATTER FILED IN PREVIOUS SESSION
SEE HOUSE, NO. 3573 OF 2023-2024.]

The Commonwealth of Massachusetts

In the One Hundred and Ninety-Fourth General Court
(2025-2026)

An Act establishing a grant program to increase the presence of mental health counselors in schools.

Be it enacted by the Senate and House of Representatives in General Court assembled, and by the authority of the same, as follows:

1 Chapter 71 of the General Laws is hereby amended by adding the following section:-

2 Section 100. (a) There is hereby established a school mental health professional grant
3 program for the purpose of increasing the number of mental health professionals employed by
4 school districts in the commonwealth to provide mental health support to students.

5 (b) The department shall award school mental health professional grants to school
6 districts that apply for grant funds in the form and manner set forth by the commissioner.

7 (c) Grant funds awarded pursuant to this section shall be used (i) to fund in part or in
8 whole the salary of any mental health professional employed by the school district or (ii) to fund

9 the cost of contracting with a third-party mental health service provider to provide mental health
10 support to the students of the school district.

11 (d) The commissioner shall adopt regulations to implement this section, including, but
12 not limited to, regulations related to any qualifications or certifications required of a mental
13 health professional whose salary will be funded in part or in whole with grant funds awarded
14 pursuant to this section.